August Cashflow Bucket Control System

Harvest Investive - Dub Dub, Kipasa, and Trade Center

Start month: August 2026 | Prepared: 03 August 2026

Purpose: Stop cash from disappearing into one general Operations pool. From August, every dollar must be assigned to one of four buckets before it moves: Rent, Salaries, Stock, or Savings/Black Box.

1. The Four-Bucket Rule

Every cash movement must belong to one of these four buckets. If a payment does not fit, it must be treated as an exception and approved by the owner before money leaves the business.

Bucket	Purpose	Allowed payments	Hard rule
Rent	Protect rent money before it gets consumed.	Shop rent, premises costs approved as rent reserve use.	Rent reserve is not spending money. Unused rent balance carries forward.
Salaries	Protect staff payroll.	Approved wages, salaries, staff advances if authorised.	Salary money cannot be borrowed for stock or petty expenses.
Stock	Fund stock orders that create saleable inventory.	Supplier payments, freight linked to stock, receiving-related costs.	Every stock payment needs supplier, item list, proof, and stock received record.
Savings / Black Box	Build retained cash and owner reserve.	Owner-approved savings, black box deposits, protected retained cash.	No withdrawal unless owner signs and reason is recorded.

2. Movement Rules

- No money moves without date, amount, bucket, reason, person requesting, person approving, and receipt/proof.
- The person who requests payment cannot be the only person approving it.
- Cash received from shops must be split into buckets before it is spent.
- Petty cash is not a fifth bucket. It is only a small payment method and must still point back to one of the four buckets.
- Generic descriptions are banned: Round, Balance, Other, Adjustment, Banking, Person-name-only, and Stock Order without supplier details.

3. Approval Levels

Amount	Approval needed	Proof needed	When paid
$0 - $20	Shop lead or MD	Receipt or petty cash slip	Same day if valid
$20.01 - $100	MD approval	Receipt plus bucket code	Same day if valid
$100.01 - $500	MD + owner approval	Receipt/proof, reason, bucket, expected benefit	Before payment unless emergency
Above $500	Owner approval before payment	Full proof pack and sign-off	Before payment only

4. August Opening Setup

Complete this once at the start of August 2026. The business must know what cash exists and where it belongs before new spending begins.

Step	Action	Owner	Done
1	Count all shop cash: Dub Dub, Kipasa, Trade Center.	Shop staff + MD	
2	Confirm bank cash and owner-held business cash.	Owner + MD	
3	Set opening balances for Rent, Salaries, Stock, Savings/Black Box.	Owner + MD	
4	Record any unpaid rent, unpaid salaries, supplier payables, or tax/banking obligations.	MD	
5	Start August daily cash close and bucket ledger.	All shops	

5. Monthly Bucket Targets

Use these targets as the first August control plan. Adjust only with owner approval.

Bucket	Monthly target	When funded	Minimum evidence
Rent	$2,000 target unless changed by owner	Weekly or daily split from shop transfers	Rent reserve register and rent receipt
Salaries	Set exact payroll budget before month starts	Before payroll week	Payroll list and signatures
Stock	Stock budget approved weekly	Before supplier payment	Supplier, item list, payment proof, stock received
Savings / Black Box	Protected reserve target	After sales close or weekly owner sweep	Deposit note and owner sign-off

6. Daily Cash Close

Every shop must close with this record. If cash is short or over, the variance must be written before staff leave.

Date	Shop	Opening cash	Cash sales	Expenses paid	Transfers to buckets	Expected cash	Actual cash	Variance	Staff sign

7. Bucket Ledger

This is the main control. Every transfer into or out of Rent, Salaries, Stock, and Savings/Black Box must appear here.

Date	Bucket	In	Out	Balance	Reason	Requested by	Approved by	Proof ref

8. Petty Cash Sign-Off

Petty cash only pays small approved items. Every petty cash payment still needs a bucket.

Date	Amount	Bucket	Paid to	Reason	Receipt yes/no	Approved by	Signature

9. Weekly Owner Report

Every Monday, the MD should send this to the owner for the previous week.

Line	Dub Dub	Kipasa	Trade Center	Total	Owner notes
Cash received					
Rent bucket balance					
Salaries bucket balance					
Stock bucket balance					
Savings / Black Box balance					
Petty cash spent					
Stock purchases paid					
Unapproved / unclear payments					
Cash variance					
Bank / physical cash held					

10. Red Flags

- Any bucket balance goes negative.
- Rent reserve is not visible as cash, bank, or signed reserve balance.
- Stock paid for but not received or not entered into inventory.
- Payment description is vague or person-name-only.
- Petty cash is topped up without receipts.
- Savings / Black Box withdrawal happens without owner signature.
- Daily cash close is skipped or signed late.

11. First August Instruction

> From 1 August 2026, do not ask only 'how much money came in?' Ask: 'Which bucket did it go into, who approved the movement, and what proof shows it is still there or was used correctly?'